ARTICLE 33. To see if the Town will raise and appropriate, transfer from free cash or available funds, or otherwise provide a sum of money for budget management and permitting software.

(Town Manager)

MOTION #1:
MOVED AND SECONDED that the Town appropriate a sum of $233,359.39 from surpluses previously appropriated from Free Cash for specific projects listed below to purchase permitting and licensing software and related services

Account	Description	Balance
0397252	Eversource A25 FTM 11/17	38,900.00
0397252	Eversource A18 STM 5/18	44,653.89
0397252	Eversource A23 FTM 11/23	96,362.89
0399672	WHS Gymnasium A34 STM 5/24	4,329.99
0398962	Multi-Purpose Sports Court at the Mystic School A18 STM 5/22	8,081.76
0398922	Multi-Purpose Sports Court Eng at the Mystic School A26 11/21	930.00
0399812	Mystic School Heating System Improvements A32 FTM 11/23	16,446.41
0398872	Winchester Center Commuter Rail A19 FTM 11/21	23,654.45
	Total	**233,359.39**

MOTION #2:
MOVED AND SECONDED that the Town appropriate a sum of $98,106.29, of which $5,612.58 is from the remaining surplus in account 0399672 WHS Gymnasium previously appropriated from Free Cash at the STM 5/24 (A34) and $92,493.71 from Free Cash for the purchase of budget management and reporting software and related professional services.

BACKGROUND: *Currently only the Building and Zoning Departments utilize OpenGov's standardized electronic permitting software, while other land use and related departments (including Conservation, Planning and Health) require either paper filing or utilize stand-alone systems that do not communicate with other departments. Expanding the OpenGov platform across departments will create a single public portal for all permits, simplifying the application process for both businesses and residents, allow for tighter tracking of applications that require permits from multiple departments, provide automated reporting and dashboards, and provide easier public access to records. This software is also configurable to support other municipal permits and licenses including those issued by the Town Clerk, DPW and the Select Board*

Budgeting software supports not only the creation of operating, capital and personnel budgets, it can create professional reports for budget management and public presentations and has a public portal which makes accessing budgetary information simple and effective. The funding requests are based on quotes for installation and annual licensing fees for both products and will cover expenses through the remainder of FY27 and FY28.

Majority Vote Required